

1. Introduction

This report documents my work in the Field Linguistics course at Stockholm University, focusing on the expression of temperature in Wakhi. Wakhi is an Eastern Pamir language spoken in the Wakhan region across Pakistan, Afghanistan, Tajikistan, and China, and is under-documented in many respects. Our consultant was Sajid Ali Alvi (born in 1987 and aged 39, from Karachi in Pakistan), a first-language Wakhi speaker who also speaks Urdu, Pashto, and English and works as a researcher in material science at Chalmers University. All data were collected in a field-methods setting at Stockholm University, in a series of 6 recorded consultant sessions at Språkstudion (Room E363).

As a group, we designed a small semantic-domain project on temperature expressions in Wakhi. We formulated two core research questions: (1) Which basic temperature concepts are distinguished in Wakhi (what does the temperature scale look like)? (2) How are these concepts distributed across different semantic domains, such as environment, body, objects, food, behaviour, and colour?

These questions were inspired by Maria Koptjevskaja-Tamm's work in *The Linguistics of Temperature*, which emphasises carefully controlled semantic elicitation for domains like temperature.

My individual contribution focused on lexicon development and interlinear glossing. At the group level, Wojciech and I mainly developed the project outline and session scripts together, and both of us participated in the consultant sessions while Emma joined team meetings online to give updates on her progress since she was an athlete and away for competitions.

To manage the shared framework, responsibilities were divided as follows:

- Emma took primary responsibility for phonetic and phonological transcription, especially for the detailed segmental analysis of selected examples.
- Wojciech handled most of the technical workflow, including recording, file naming, and segmentation in Praat, and led the drafting of the general methods and results sections for the group presentation.
- My main tasks were to design and refine elicitation questions, carry out morpheme-by-morpheme glossing (especially for the Session 3, A6 "Making Tea" text and other Session 3 segments), and compile the temperature lexicon and domain-based tables that later formed the core of our presentation's results section.

This portfolio brings together: (i) the original project outline and my transcription-and-glossing assignment, (ii) an overview of the data and elicitation materials we worked with, (iii) an individual write-up of the findings from the group project focusing on my sub-project (temperature lexicon and glossing), and (iv) reflections on my learning process in relation to field methods, transcription, glossing, and semantic analysis. I will not rewrite the graded assignments, but I will comment on them based on the feedback I received and the further insights I gained while working towards the final presentation.

2. Core assignments included in the portfolio

A. Project Outline

Our initial project outline submitted was written jointly by Emma Fransson, myself (Ugochi Winnie Okafor), and Wojciech Stempniak. It established the conceptual and practical framework for the group project.

We defined the domain of study as the semantic field of temperature in Wakhi, asking how a Wakhan speaker talks about temperature terms like "hot", "warm", "cool", and "cold" in everyday contexts. The outline stated that we would focus on meaning rather than trying to describe a full grammatical subsystem such as all adjectives or tense-aspect. Within this domain, we narrowed our questions to three tightly connected points:

1. which basic temperature concepts are distinguished,
2. how these concepts are used across contexts (body, environment, objects/food), and
3. whether any extended or metaphorical uses of temperature expressions appear in our data.

The outline specified a data collection plan centred on four main consultant sessions (Sessions 3–6, approximately 50 minutes each), using a Zoom Handy Recorder H2 and later segmentation and annotation in Praat. We planned to combine semi-structured interviews and short narratives with stimulus-based elicitation and targeted lexical questions. Prompts targeted situations such as the coldest and hottest days the speaker remembered, seasonal weather in the Wakhan region, preparations for winter, and procedural descriptions of making and drinking tea. The core idea, following Koptjevskaja-Tamm's book on temperature, was to use small, concrete scenarios to elicit temperature language in different domains (air, water, food, body, behaviour and emotions, colour).

The submitted outline also detailed our session structure:

- Session 3 (11.02) – main recording of Wakhi responses to temperature-related prompts, without analytical interruption.
- Session 4 (18.02) – replay and segmentation of the material, eliciting sentence-by-sentence English translations and follow-up questions, including questions about metaphorical uses (“cold person”, “heated argument”, “warm colour”).
- Sessions 5 (25.02) and 6 (04.03) – word-by-word translation and clarification sessions, during which we checked lexical correspondences, asked additional semantic questions, and worked on morpheme-by-morpheme glossing for selected texts.

In terms of division of labour, the outline formally assigned:

- session script and recording to Wojciech,
- trimming and orthographic transcription to Wojciech,
- phonetic transcription to Emma,
- morpheme-by-morpheme glossing to me,
- lexicon compilation to me, and
- presentation preparation to all three of us.

In practice, we respected these roles. Wojciech operated the recorder and managed the shared Nextcloud folder with files like [260211_S3a_A1_Weather_Change.wav](#), [260211_S3a_A6_Making_Tea.wav](#), and corresponding TextGrids; Emma concentrated on the phonetic analysis; and I focused on lexical analysis, glossing, and the design of elicitation questions for semantic contrasts.

Looking back, the project outline captured our goals and workflow quite accurately. The actual sessions followed our plan. For instance, we used Session 3 to elicit short Wakhi narratives on weather, special hot/cold experiences, and tea-making; Session 4 to replay and translate; and Sessions 5 and 6 to gloss and probe semantic distinctions. One minor difference is that our stimulus work was less visual than originally imagined (we did not use pictures and more verbal scenarios), but the underlying idea of controlled, scenario-based elicitation guided our questions throughout.

B. Transcription and Glossing Assignment

The second core assignment was my transcription and glossing of text A6 “Making Tea” from Session 3. In this task, I created a detailed metadata, a phonetic and lexical transcription, and a morpheme-by-morpheme gloss of a short procedural text, following the Leipzig Glossing Rules.

The metadata section of the assignment specified:

- **Language:** Wakhi (Indo-European, Pamir).
- **Speaker:** Sajid Ali Alvi (male, L1 Wakhi).
- **Context:** Describing the Process of Making Tea.
- **Place:** Stockholm University (Södra Huset E, recording studio at Room 363).
- **Recorded by:** Wojciech and myself.
- **Date and time:** 11 February 2026, 17:00–17:47 CET.
- **Recording file:** [260211_S3a_A6_Making_Tea.wav](#).
- **Segment used:** 11:11–11:49 (38 seconds).

For this assignment, I provided interlinear transcription for six sentences, each with (a) a phonetic line in IPA, (b) a segmental/lexical line, (c) a morpheme-by-morpheme gloss line, and (d) a free translation. Table 1 summarises the six sentences and their English translations on the basis of the lexical line.

Lexical line	English translation
ska ragnig-ef zerdig-f ska din ha yuk-f ra kadin	You put the pot on the fire and pour water in.
aval dangk-ti tfai ra kadin	First, put the tea in the pot.
yan-if woz zak liter-in mat vita zak ha peft	And then it is left for a little while and it boils.
pisak jiru vitja	Then the cooking starts.
yadge-f ra kadin zak woz padze	There you pour in a little more milk and let it cook.
yan-if tfai teor wost	Then the tea is ready.

Table 1. Session 3, text A6 “Making Tea”: sentences and translations

In the notes, I discussed several recurring elements. I analysed the suffixes -ef, -f, -if, and -ti as fillers or discourse-like suffixes: for example, -ef in *ragnig-ef* was glossed as PRS.FILL? because the consultant described it as a present-tense filler in this procedural context, while -f and -if were glossed simply as FILL where no clear tense–aspect meaning could be established. I treated *ra* as a locative/postposition, glossed as LOC or in.LOC / there.LOC depending on whether I emphasised its lexical meaning “in/there” or its grammatical case-like function.

I analysed *vita/vitja/wost* as a light verb meaning ‘happen, come to be’, noting that Sentence 3 uses *vita*, Sentence 4 uses *vitja*, and Sentence 6 uses *wost*. I differentiated *peft* ‘boil (liquid)’ from *padze* and *pisak* ‘cook (food)’, arguing that *peft* is used specifically when the water boils, whereas *padze* and *pisak* describe ongoing cooking or simmering phases. I also pointed out that the 2SG subject is inferred rather than overtly expressed, in line with the Leipzig rule that non-overt elements are not added in the gloss line.

From a phonetics and transcription perspective, this assignment made the limitations of my first IPA attempt visible. I realised that my IPA line was too close to the lexical line and that keyboard noise affected perception. In the presentation work, we corrected *katin* to *kadin* and refined forms like /ik 'ranju/ and /'ta:odi mats/. In other words, whole segments and even syllables were missing from the IPA line, so the relationship between phonetic detail and the more abstract lexical line was not clear enough. In subsequent work for the project, I treated this first IPA as a cautious starting point and focused on improving the transcription of key forms (including the verb glossed as *thit* ‘burn’, where I adjusted the dental/aspirated consonant in IPA) on the basis of repeated listening.

The feedback on this assignment was generally positive but highlighted several important points that shaped my portfolio work:

1. For metadata, I was encouraged to add a more precise specification of the variety and origin of the speaker (Sajid’s background in Karachi and his Wakhi-speaking heritage from the Wakhan region) and to mention explicitly that the recording was made in a field-methods class at Stockholm University, in room E363.
2. Regarding structure, the interlinear layout was appreciated, but my extensive comments under each sentence were considered easier to read if moved into footnotes or a separate analysis section. In this portfolio, I follow that advice by keeping the interlinear text itself cleaner and shifting most commentary into the findings and reflections sections.
3. For glossing, the feedback confirmed that I applied Leipzig Glossing Rules correctly overall but pointed out that I need a clear list of abbreviations (both for standard LGR labels and my own labels like FILL), and that I should avoid glosses like in.LOC for a single morpheme. One morpheme-break / gloss mismatch in Sentence 2 was also noted and corrected.
4. For transcription, the examiner emphasised that my phonetic line was too narrow and incomplete and that keyboard noise made detailed phonetic analysis harder.

In this portfolio, I will not be rewriting the assignment, but I will build on this feedback in two ways. First, in the findings section of this report, I will present revised glossing and lexicon tables where I adopt clearer abbreviations, avoid double glosses like in.LOC, and incorporate later corrections such as treating *kadin*

(not *katin*) as the single verb 'put/pour'. Second, in the reflections section, I will explicitly discuss what I learned about phonetic transcription, about the limits of my first IPA attempt, and about how this influenced my later work on the temperature lexicon and domain analysis.

3. Data, metadata, and elicitation

A. Recorded materials and metadata

Our group worked mainly with material from Session 3 and its follow-up sessions, all recorded in the field methods class at Stockholm University. The core Session 3 file set, segmented and named by Wojciech in Praat, consists of:

- 260211_S3a_A1_Weather_Change.wav / .TextGrid – general description of weather changes in Wakhan.
- 260211_S3a_A2_Good_Weather.wav / .TextGrid – good weather and preferred hiking times.
- 260211_S3a_A3_Winter_Preparation.wav / .TextGrid – how people prepare for winter.
- 260211_S3a_A4_Favourite_Season.wav / .TextGrid – favourite season and reasons.
- 260211_S3a_A5_Boiling_Water.wav / .TextGrid – boiling water.
- 260211_S3a_A6_Making_Tea.wav / .TextGrid – making tea (my individual glossing assignment).
- 260211_S3a_A7_Water_Too_Hot.wav / .TextGrid – effects of water/tea being too hot.
- 260211_S3a_A8_Water_Got_Cold.wav / .TextGrid – water becoming cold.
- 260211_S3a_A9_Coldest_Day_Ever.wav / .TextGrid – coldest day the consultant remembers.
- 260211_S3a_A10_Hottest_Day_Ever.wav / .TextGrid – hottest day the consultant remembers.

All recordings were stored in a shared Nextcloud folder and available on Athena. Wojciech's segmentation in Praat provided time-aligned tiers for each text, which Emma and I then used for phonetic transcription and glossing. Session 3 was followed by:

- Session 4 (18.02) – replay of the A1–A10 recordings, eliciting Wakhi repetition and sentence-level English translations, plus additional questions (including metaphorical uses such as “cold person”, “heated argument”, and “warm colour”).
- Session 5 (25.02) – focused largely on glossing A2 (Emma), A6 (my text), and A3 (Wojciech), with clarifications on lexical choices and morphology.
- Session 6 (04.03) – additional glossing of A1, A4, A5, A7–A10 and follow-up questions to fill semantic gaps.

The metadata for my A6 assignment (Making Tea) focuses on well-documented texts covering environmental descriptions, daily activities (boiling water, making tea), extreme temperature experiences, and short explanations of preferences (favourite season, good weather). This combination of narrative and procedural genres turned out to be ideal for studying temperature expressions in natural discourse, while the short prompts ensured we still had many controlled contexts.

B. Elicitation design and semantic focus

A key part of my contribution was the design and refinement of elicitation questions targeting the temperature domain. I was influenced by Maria Koptjevskaja-Tamm's *The Linguistics of Temperature*, which emphasises:

- keeping the domain small and well defined,
- using concrete scenarios and contrasts,
- and probing systematically across different semantic domains (environment, body, food and drink, objects, emotions, and colour).

Based on that, and building on our original project outline, I developed a set of questions that we used mainly in Sessions 3 and 4, and refined in Sessions 5 and 6. They fall into several groups.

(a) Seasonal and environmental temperature

These questions targeted weather and seasons in the Wakhan region:

- “Please tell me a little bit about how the weather changes during the year in the Wakhan region. For instance, if you went hiking now, in February, how would you explain to someone who is interested in hiking what the best times and months are and why?”
- “How do people prepare for the winter?”
- “Tell me about your favourite season and why you like it the most.”

These prompts produced the A1–A4 texts and gave us expressions like /syr/ ‘cold’, /flut/ ‘lukewarm’, /fund/ ‘warm’, and descriptions with ‘snow’/zem/, ‘spring’/bohor/, and ‘high-altitude sun’/tis jiri/.

(b) Personal experiences of extreme heat and cold

Here the goal was to elicit maximal points on the temperature scale:

- “Can you tell me about the coldest day you remember?”
- “Can you tell me about the hottest day you remember?”

The resulting A9 and A10 texts gave us temperature descriptions in degrees, as well as expressions for “very cold/ice-like” and “very hot”, and helped us see how the speaker talks about unusual extremes.

(c) Everyday objects and activities (teapot domain)

To connect temperature to objects, liquids, and bodily sensations, I used step-wise prompts around tea making:

- “Imagine you make tea. Describe the process from boiling the water until you drink it.”
- “What happens if you try to drink it too soon?”
- “And if you forget it and come back later?”

These produced the A5–A8 texts, including:

- the procedural description I glossed in A6 “Making Tea”, with verbs /peft/ ‘boil’, /padze/ and /pisak/ ‘cook’, and light verbs /vita, ‘vitja, wost/ ‘happen, come to be’;
- the short sentence for water becoming cold, /syr ‘vitk/;
- and the body-sensation example with hot tea burning the tongue, combining /mats/ or /‘ta:odi mats/ with /thit/ ‘burn’.

(d) Cross-domain contrasts and metaphorical uses

Focusing on Koptjevskaja-Tamm’s emphasis on domain contrasts, I also prepared targeted questions used mainly in Session 4:

- “In previous conversations, you used /syr/ for ‘cold’ when you say things like ‘The water is cold’ or ‘That is cold’. If you want to describe a person’s behaviour as unfriendly or distant, like ‘That student was cold to me during the session’, what would you say in Wakhi?”
– This led us to /baghet/ as a separate lexeme for ‘cold/mean/unfriendly person’.
- “Please say these sentences in Wakhi: ‘The stone is cold when I touch it’, ‘The room is cold’, and ‘I am cold’. If you use /syr/ for all of them, how would you make each of them stronger or weaker (e.g. ‘very’, ‘a bit’, ‘too’)?”
– This gave us insight into degree marking and how far /syr/ extends across the body and environment.
- “If water, air, or food is neither clearly warm nor clearly cold (just in between), what would you normally say in Wakhi? Do you have a special word or only a phrase like ‘not cold, not warm’?”
– This question was crucial for identifying /flut/ ‘lukewarm’ as a middle term.
- “How would you say ‘This water is warmer than that water’?”
– This was aimed at comparative uses and expectations.
- “How do you say ‘The argument became very heated’?”
– This elicited the use of ‘Karha’ and the idiom ‘*Tele mana gara ga geto*’ (hold each other by the collar) instead of a temperature word.
- “Do you say anything like ‘warm heart’ or ‘cold heart’ in Wakhi? If yes, how?”
- “Can you use a temperature word for a colour or light, like ‘warm colour’?”
– These questions tested whether temperature adjectives extend to emotions and colour, and led us to the conclusion that the speaker uses separate expressions like /os’moni sabs/ ‘sky green’ and does not say “warm colour” using the temperature words for ‘warm’ /fund/ or ‘lukewarm’ /flut/.

Together, these elicitation questions structured our sessions and directly shaped the lexicon and observations I later assembled. They also illustrate the methodological shift I experienced during the course. This means that I stopped thinking of “temperature words” as just a vocabulary list, but saw them as part of a structured semantic field that must be tested across carefully chosen contexts and compared against possible metaphors.

4. Findings: Wakhi temperature lexicon and domains (my sub-project)

A. Abstract

This sub-project examined the temperature lexicon in Wakhi, focusing on its internal structure and its distribution across semantic domains. The data were drawn from elicitation sessions, short narratives, and glossed texts (A1–A8), including a procedural tea-making text. The analysis identified a scalar temperature system with clearly defined lexical anchors, degree marking, and change-of-state expressions. The findings further showed that temperature terms were systematically used in environmental and food-related contexts but were not extended metaphorically to behaviour, emotion, or colour. Instead, these domains relied on distinct lexical items and idiomatic expressions.

B. Introduction

This sub-project investigated how temperature is expressed in Wakhi, with attention to both lexical organisation and domain-specific usage.

The analysis was guided by two research questions:

- **RQ1:** What lexical items and grammatical structures are used to express temperature in Wakhi, and how do they form a coherent scale?
- **RQ2:** How are temperature expressions distributed across semantic domains such as environment, food, body, behaviour, and colour?

The aim is to identify both the structure of the temperature system and the limits of its extension across domains.

C. Methods

- The data analysed in this sub-project came from elicitation sessions, short narratives, and glossed texts (A1–A8). These included descriptions of weather and seasons, as well as a procedural text on tea-making (A6), which provided detailed examples of temperature in use.
- Elicitation was used to identify lexical items and test possible combinations, including the compatibility of temperature terms with colour and behavioural meanings. Narrative and procedural texts were used to observe how these forms occur in connected speech.
- The glossing follows standard interlinear practices, with attention to lexical meaning, morphological marking, and clause structure. Particular focus was placed on predication, degree marking, and change-of-state constructions involving temperature expressions.

The project was conducted collaboratively. Data collection and elicitation were carried out as a group, while glossing and analysis were distributed across members. This sub-project focuses on my analysis of the temperature lexicon, including the reconstruction of the temperature scale and the comparison of its use across domains, based on the shared datasets.

D. Results

1. Temperature scale (RQ1)

The data show a structured temperature scale with distinct lexical items marking different points along the continuum.

Cold

- /syr/ – ‘cold’, used for weather and environmental conditions
- /syr-i/ – ‘it is cold’, with -i marking predication
- /syr ‘vitk/ – ‘become cold’, expressing change of state

- /ik 'ranʃu/ – 'very cold, ice-like', marking extreme cold

Middle

- /ʃlut/ – 'lukewarm, in-between', used for mild or transitional conditions

Warm and hot

- /ʃund/ – 'warm', also present in the month name Shundposh 'August'
- /garm/ – 'hot', especially for weather
- /mats/, /ʃa'mats/ – 'hot / very hot', used for both weather and liquids
- /'ta:odi mats/ – 'extremely hot', especially for liquids that are too hot to drink

Degree marking

- /ʃaft/ – 'very, intensely', used to increase scalar intensity (e.g. /ʃaft mats/)

These items form a scale from extreme cold to extreme heat:

/ik 'ranʃu/ → /syr/ → /ʃlut/ → /ʃund, garm, mats, ʃa'mats/ → /'ta:odi mats/

The system also includes grammatical resources such as predication (/syr-i/) and change-of-state marking (/syr 'vitk/).

2 Distribution across domains (RQ2)

a) Environment and seasons

Temperature expressions are most consistently used in environmental descriptions.

- /syr/ and /ik 'ranʃu/ describe cold winter conditions
- /ʃlut/ is used for mild or transitional weather
- /ʃund/, /garm/, /mats/, and /ʃa'mats/ describe warm and hot conditions
- /tis 'dʒiri/ refers to strong, uncomfortable solar heat

Seasonal terms such as /bohor/ 'spring' and /zem/ 'snow' co-occur with temperature expressions and structure descriptions of seasonal change.

b) Food, liquids, and processes

In this domain, temperature expressions co-occur with process verbs.

- /mats/ and /ʃa'mats/ describe hot water and tea
- /'ta:odi mats/ describes liquids that are too hot to consume

Relevant process verbs include:

- /peft/ – 'boil (liquid)'
- /padze/ – 'cook (food)'
- /pisak/ – 'cook', attested in contexts where cooking begins

Change-of-state and result are expressed through:

- /vita, 'vitja, wost/ – 'happen, come to be'
- /to:r wost/ – 'be ready'

c) Body sensations

Temperature is expressed through its physical effects rather than direct description of the body.

- /'ta:odi mats/ describes very hot liquids
- /θit/ 'burn' encodes the resulting bodily sensation

d) Behaviour and emotion

Temperature expressions are not used in this domain.

- /baghet/ is used for an unfriendly or distant person
- /karha/ refers to anger or conflict
- idiomatic expressions describe interpersonal tension

e) Colour and light

Temperature terms do not extend into the colour domain.

- /sik/ 'red' functions as a basic colour term
- *sik mats* 'red hot' is rejected
- intensity is expressed through /yɔftʃ/
- /os'moni sabs/ ('sky green') is used for blue or blue-green

3. Structural observations

Some grammatical features are directly involved in temperature expressions:

- the suffix -i marks predication in forms such as /syr-i/
- change-of-state is expressed through verbs such as /vit-/
- degree is expressed through separate lexical items such as /yɔftʃ/

E. Discussion

The results show that Wakhi has a clearly structured temperature system with distinct lexical and grammatical resources. This system is consistently applied in domains where physical temperature is relevant, particularly environment and food.

A key finding is the absence of metaphorical extension. Unlike English, temperature terms are not used to describe behaviour or emotion. Instead, these meanings are expressed through separate lexical items such as /baghet/ and /karha/, as well as idiomatic expressions.

A similar restriction is observed in the colour domain, where temperature terms are not used to describe colour or intensity. Intensity is instead marked through degree expressions such as /yɔftʃ/.

In the food and liquid domain, temperature expressions interact closely with process verbs. While there are indications of functional differences between verbs such as /padze/ and /pisak/, the available data are not sufficient to establish these distinctions conclusively.

The analysis is limited by the size and distribution of the dataset. Some areas, such as cold or lukewarm liquids, are underrepresented, and further elicitation would be needed to confirm less frequent patterns.

F. Conclusion

This study identifies a structured temperature lexicon in Wakhi, organised along a scalar system and supported by grammatical marking. Temperature expressions are consistently used in domains involving physical temperature but do not extend metaphorically to behaviour, emotion, or colour. Instead, these domains rely on distinct lexical and idiomatic resources. Further data would allow for a more detailed account of verb distinctions and less frequent temperature uses.

5. Reflections on method and learning

This section reflects on what I learned over the course in relation to semantic-domain fieldwork, transcription and glossing, and collaborative work with a single consultant. It draws on course readings, especially work on the linguistics of temperature, as well as practical experience from data collection, analysis, and feedback on the A6 assignment.

A. From word list to semantic domain

At the beginning of the course, I approached “temperature in Wakhi” primarily as a vocabulary task. My initial focus was on identifying direct equivalents of words such as ‘hot’, ‘cold’, and ‘warm’. However, through the course, and especially through engagement with typological work on temperature, I came to understand temperature as a structured semantic domain rather than a simple list of lexical items.

This shift became clear during the design of elicitation questions. Instead of asking for isolated translations, I began to frame questions in terms of contexts and contrasts, such as how temperature is expressed across different situations, including environment, body, and liquids, and how change of state is encoded. This approach made it possible to identify patterns that would not emerge from word lists alone, including the role of degree marking and the absence of certain expected extensions.

One important outcome of this shift was the identification of negative evidence. For example, while temperature metaphors are common in languages such as English and Swedish, the Wakhi data did not show comparable extensions to behaviour, emotion, or colour. This absence became analytically relevant only once the domain was explored systematically across multiple frames.

B. Transcription, glossing, and dealing with uncertainty

The A6 “Making Tea” assignment was my first attempt at producing a full interlinear glossed text with IPA transcription. The feedback I received on this assignment shaped how I approached the data in the rest of the project and in this portfolio.

One key issue was the level of detail in transcription. My initial phonetic line did not consistently capture all audible segments, which made it difficult to relate the phonetic form to lexical and morphological analysis. While I have not reworked the original submission, this limitation affected how confidently I could interpret certain forms in later analysis. It also made me more aware of the importance of distinguishing clearly between phonetic transcription and more abstract representations.

The feedback also highlighted the need for consistency and clarity in glossing. I became more systematic in using a stable set of abbreviations, avoiding multiple glosses for a single form, and marking uncertain elements explicitly. In particular, I treated filler-like elements and unclear suffixes cautiously, rather than assigning them fixed grammatical meanings without sufficient evidence. This was important for maintaining a clear distinction between temperature expressions themselves and the grammatical or discourse elements that accompany them.

Another point was that I became more comfortable with uncertainty. In several cases, such as possible distinctions between verbs meaning ‘cook’, the available data were limited. Instead of over-interpreting these patterns, I chose to describe what could be observed and to indicate where further data would be needed. This reflects a broader methodological point from the course, namely that small datasets require careful and transparent handling.

C. Working with one consultant and in a team

Working with a single consultant highlighted both the strengths and limitations of the data. The patterns identified in this project, including the structured temperature scale and its distribution across domains, are consistent within the dataset but remain based on one speaker. This means that the findings should be treated as provisional and not necessarily representative of Wakhi more broadly.

At the same time, the project demonstrated how much can be achieved through careful collaboration. The division of roles within the group allowed different aspects of the data to be handled effectively. Data collection, recording, and organisation provided a reliable corpus for analysis, while phonetic input supported more detailed transcription. My own contribution focused on elicitation design and the organisation of lexical and domain-based patterns, which formed the basis of the analysis presented in this portfolio.

This collaborative structure made it possible to connect raw data, transcription, and semantic analysis in a coherent way, while also making clear that the final outcomes depend on shared work across the group.

D. Development of methodological understanding

Over the course, I developed a more structured approach to field linguistics, particularly in relation to semantic domains. One key insight was the importance of designing elicitation tasks that systematically cover contrasts, rather than relying on spontaneous examples alone.

I also became more aware of the relationship between different types of data. Narrative and procedural texts provided more natural usage, while elicitation allowed for targeted testing of specific forms and constructions. Combining these approaches made it possible to both identify patterns and test their limits.

Another important development was understanding how theoretical work can inform practical decisions. The typological perspective on temperature guided the choice of domains to investigate and helped frame the analysis in terms of cross-linguistic comparison, even when the data did not align with expected patterns.

E. What I would do differently

This project also highlighted areas for improvement in future fieldwork.

First, I would design a more systematic elicitation framework from the start, for example by mapping temperature values across different domains and ensuring that each combination is tested. This would help avoid gaps in the dataset.

Second, I would incorporate more controlled tasks alongside natural data, such as short translation contrasts or structured prompts, to better isolate specific meanings and constructions.

Third, I would pay closer attention to recording quality and to the organisation of transcription from the beginning, particularly the distinction between phonetic detail and more abstract representation.